Useful information for travel

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We will provide you with useful travel information that you want to check again for your second trip, as well as those who travel to Hokkaido for the first time. It is full of information that you must check before traveling, such as the temperature in Hokkaido, the appropriate clothing for each season, and the precautions when driving. Gathering information in advance is the first step to a fun trip. Let's start with full preparation to create better memories!

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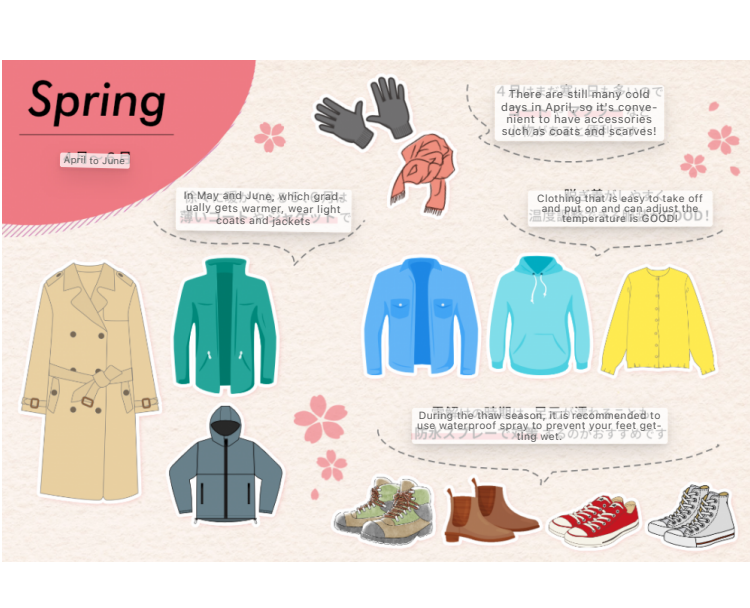
Open +

Useful information on clothing and shoes for each season

Hokkaido, the northernmost part of Japan, has a very different climate from Honshu. Hokkaido's climate is characterized by the highest and lowest temperatures of a month, and the large difference in temperatures in the morning and evening during the day. I'm planning to go to Hokkaido, but what kind of clothes should I wear? And you're also worried about choosing clothes.
It is essential to choose clothes that match the unique climate of Hokkaido so that it does not get colder than I thought. We will introduce recommended clothing and convenient goods for each season, so please use them as a reference for your trip.

※Temperature: From data from the Japan Meteorological Agency from 1991 to 2020

・Recommeded clothing for spring (April to June) and summer (July to August)



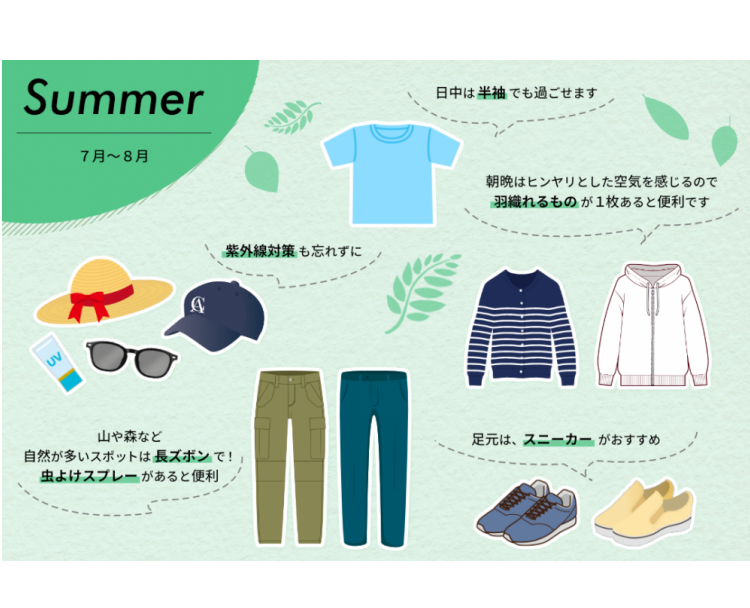
Recommended clothing for spring (April to June)

Spring when various flowers, including cherry blossoms and Shibazakura, begin to bloom. Cherry blossoms in Hokkaido are at their best in early May. By the way, Hokkaido is characterized by plum blossoms and cherry blossoms blooming at the same time.
April to June is the image of the warmth of March in Tokyo. However, unlike Tokyo, which is slowly getting warmer, cold weather continues in the case of Hokkaido. Even in April, snow can accumulate, so don't be careless.

●April
・In addition to coats, it is convenient to have cold-proof goods that can be added depending on the temperature, such as gloves and scarves.
・Wear non-slip shoes because there are many places where snow remains.

●May to June
・It may suddenly get cold in the morning and evening, so prepare jackets such as thin coats and jackets.
・We recommend layering that can be adjusted in temperature, such as cardigans and hoodies.

[Reference Average temperature in April]
Sapporo 7.3 degrees (Tokyo 14.3 degrees)
[Reference Average temperature in May]
Sapporo 13 degrees (Tokyo 18.8 degrees)
[Reference Average temperature in June]
Sapporo 17 degrees (Tokyo 21.9 degrees)

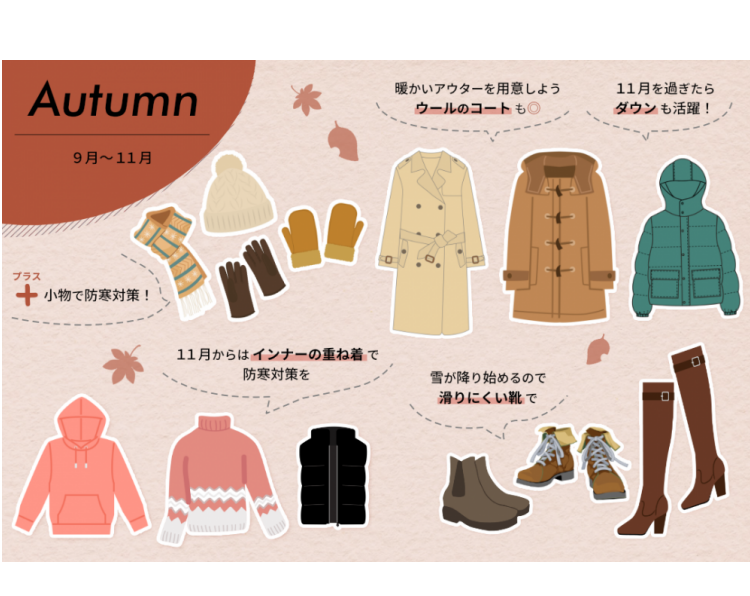


Recommended clothing for summer (July to August)

July and August are the best season for sightseeing in Hokkaido with a crisp climate, when flowers such as lavender are in full bloom. The pleasant climate like early summer in Tokyo will continue.
At this time of year, short sleeves are OK during the day. However, I feel cold in places at high altitudes, after the sun goes down, or when the weather collapses. Considering the temperature difference between day and night, it is convenient to have a thin feather fabric such as a hoodie or a light cardigan!
In addition, if you go to a place rich in nature for mountain climbing or trekking, long pants are best to avoid problems such as injury, insect bite, etc. It's a time when many creatures are active, so you need to be careful!

[Reference Average temperature in July]
Sapporo 21.1 degrees (Tokyo 25.7 degrees)
[Reference Average temperature in August]
Sapporo 22.3 degrees (Tokyo 26.9 degrees)

・Recommended clothing for autumn (September to November) and winter (December to March)


Autumn
9月〜11月
暖かいアウターを用意しよう ウールのコートも◎
11月を過ぎたら ダウンも活躍！
プラス 小物で防寒対策！
11月からはインナーの重ね着で防寒対策を
雪が降り始めるので滑りにくい靴で

Recommended clothing for autumn (September to November)

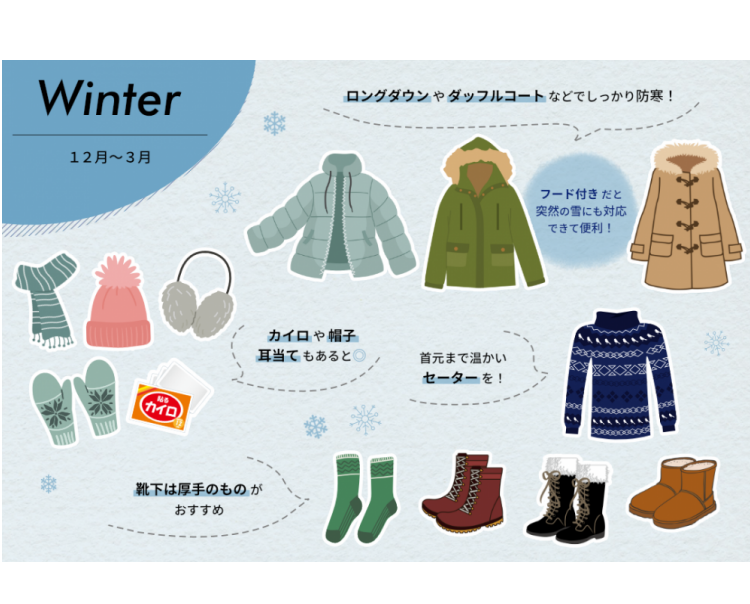
In autumn, the perceived temperature is low even during the day. Autumn leaves can be seen from September, and the first snow is observed from late October to early November, and it is the season of winter preparation in no time. Therefore, autumn is actually a difficult season to choose clothes and belongings. Early September is as easy as summer. However, it gets chilly in the morning and evening from around mid-year, so September in Hokkaido is like October in Honshu. It's safe to have long sleeves and a coat. From late October to early November, the season changes from autumn to winter at once. Therefore, take good measures against the cold with a thick coat and a long-sleeved inner. If you wear tights, you can rest assured that they are more than 80 denier!

●September
・It will be chilly in the morning and evening, so prepare long sleeves and a coat.

●October to November
・Thin down jackets and thick coats take good measures against the cold.
・From late October to November, it is convenient to have a scarf and gloves.

●November
・It's time for the first snow to start falling even on the plains. Wear thin down or thick coats for the outerwear, and layer the inner to make it easier to adjust the temperature.

[Reference Average temperature in September]
Sapporo 18.6 degrees (Tokyo 23.3 degrees)
[Reference Average temperature in October]
Sapporo 12.1 degrees (Tokyo 18.0 degrees)
[Reference November average temperature]
Sapporo 5.2 degrees (Tokyo 12.5 degrees)


Winter
12月〜3月
ロングダウンやダッフルコートなどでしっかり防寒！
フード付きだと突然の雪にも対応できて便利！
カイロや帽子耳当てもあると◎
首元まで温かいセーターを！
カイロ
靴下は厚手のものがおすすめ

Recommended clothing for winter (December to March)

Winter clothing that bothers travelers the most. Especially if you live in an area where it doesn't snow, you don't know how much cold you need.
In December, the cold suddenly intensified, and the average daily temperature in Sapporo, which is in the urban area, is below freezing. Even on days when you feel warm during the day, it gets colder at night, so even on good weather days, it is a trick to enjoy your trip to take good measures against the cold.
Especially from December to February, when it is winter, let's combine thick down and coats with warm inners such as heat tech.
It is essential to take measures against the cold, but the heating is working indoors and in the car, so it is convenient to wear layers that are easy to take off and put on.

●December to March
・It is recommended to wear an inner with excellent thermal insulation, such as heat tech. Jeans are hard to dry when wet, so be careful.
・Just layer the inner down under the outerwear you have to increase the warmth! The thin and foldable type that is convenient to carry is convenient when traveling.
・Warmer to apply → When you are at an outdoor event, put a warmer for shoes to prevent cold from the toes.
・Cold-proof goods such as thick tights of 110 denier or higher, muffs and earmuffs are essential.
・The large-format stole can be wrapped around the neck or used as a knee-hand, so it's safe to have one.

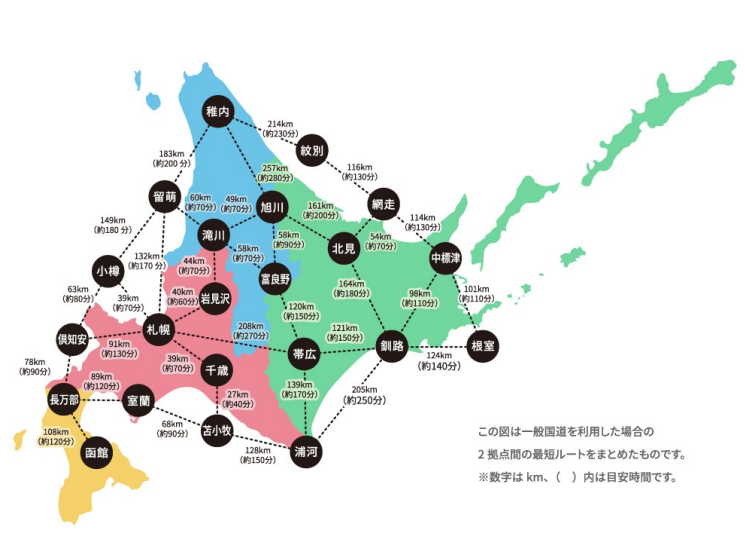
[Reference Average temperature in December]
Sapporo -0.9 degrees (Tokyo 7.7 degrees)
[Reference January average temperature]
Sapporo -3.2 degrees (Tokyo 5.4 degrees)
[Reference February average temperature]
Sapporo -2.7 degrees (Tokyo 6.1 degrees)
[Reference Average temperature in March]
Sapporo 1.1 degrees (Tokyo 9.4 degrees)

Column

Detachable non-slip is also used!

Snow boots are ideal because snowy roads are ideal, but it is troublesome to buy them for travel... "Detachable non-slip spikes" are recommended. By wearing it on ordinary boots or sneakers, it will be much less slippery. It is also sold at convenience stores and specialty stores in Hokkaido, and it is possible to purchase online in advance. Don't forget your warm gloves!

Let's know! Hokkaido's sense of scale



When planning a trip within Hokkaido, it is recommended to check the distance and travel time between each city. It looks close on the map, but it is completely different from the distance in Honshu, so if you make an unreasonable plan, it may be a disappointing result that the day will end just by moving.
If possible, it is best to drive about 300 km a day while taking turns with two or more people.

If it's a trip of 2 nights and 3 days, there are 2 to 3 destinations. First of all, after you have a spot that you definitely want to go to, let's find a tourist spot that you can enjoy around there.

There are a total of 12 airports in Hokkaido, so if you use local airports such as Hakodate, Asahikawa, Kushiro, and Obihiro for the outbound route, you can enjoy your trip efficiently by using local airports such as Hakodate, Asahikawa, Kushiro, and Obihiro. Some car rental companies have plans that allow you to return at another airport if you pay a drop-off fee, so please check it out.

Click here for "Access in the road" →
Enlarge the map and travel time (PDF) →

Points to note when driving

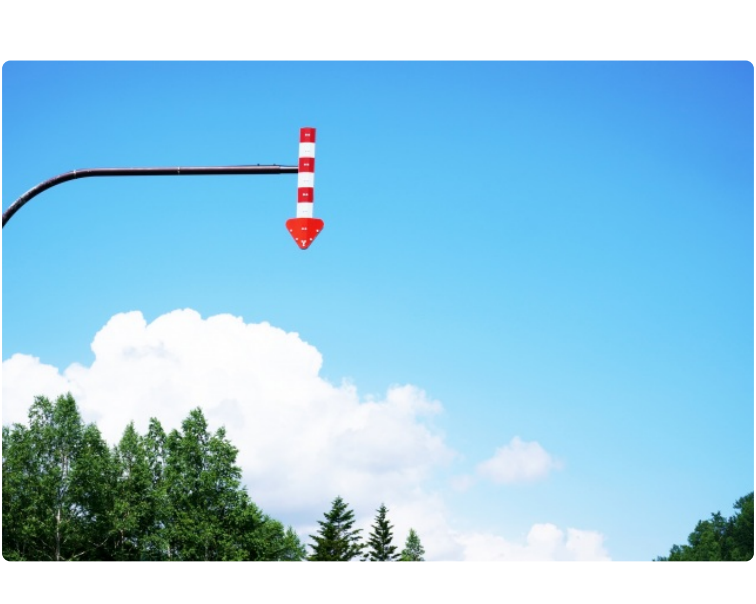
It is convenient to rent a car when traveling in a large Hokkaido. The long, long, single-way drive is very refreshing, but it is also full of dangers that are unique to Hokkaido.

National highways are well maintained to make it easy to drive, but the movement between cities is long and there are many straight roads, so you may exceed the speed limit when you notice it. Driving too fast can easily lead to delays in responding to sudden situations and accidents, so be careful when driving.
Also, animals often jump out. In particular, some deers weigh more than 100 kg, so if they collide, it can lead to a major accident that will break down the car. If you see an animal even far away, you need to take measures such as slowing down.

When driving, do not make unreasonable trips, and make good use of convenient expressways. There are few gas stations in the mountainous areas, and only about 10% of the total number of 24-hour stores are open, so please try to refuel early. Winter driving is dangerous, so it is not recommended for those who are not used to it. Drive safely and enjoy a fun drive.

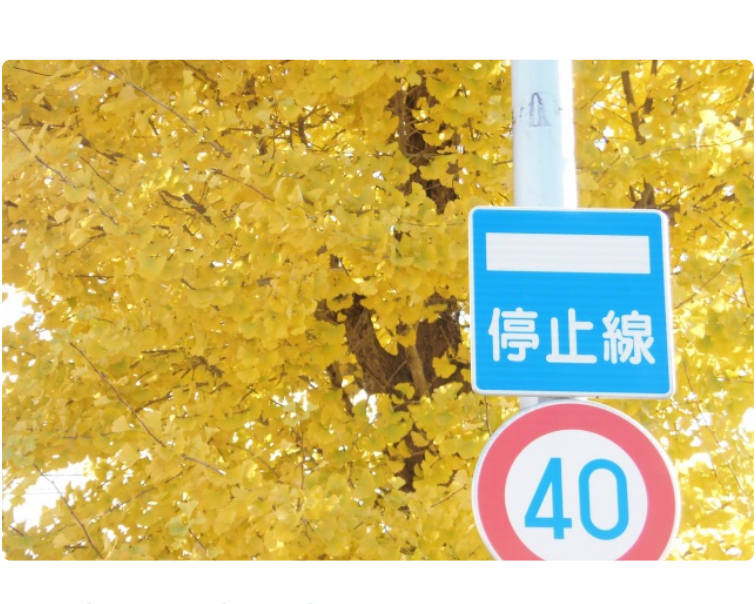
Road signs unique to Hokkaido

Even if you live in Hokkaido, it's obvious, but there are signs that are rare nationwide. It is convenient to know the signs unique to Hokkaido, which is surrounded by nature and has heavy snow in winter! Even if it's the same sign, there are various things, such as glowing and different pictures, so it's also interesting to compare the differences.



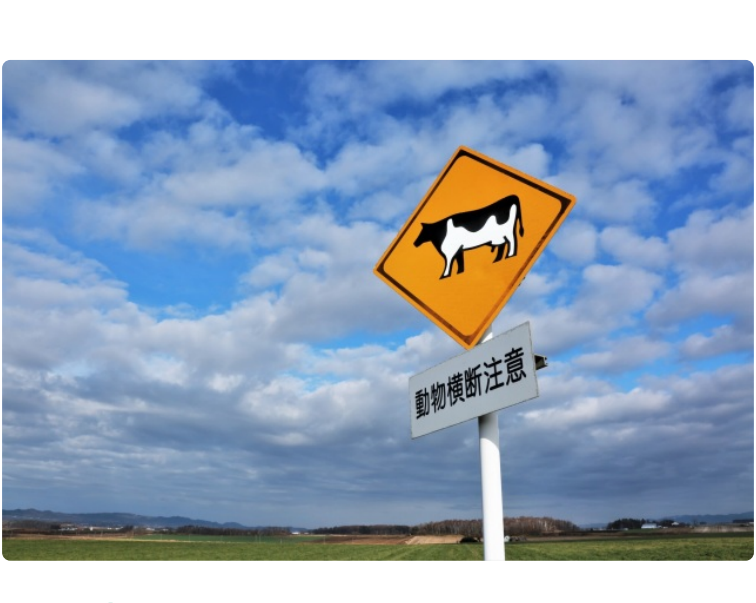
Pole with arrow feathers

The sign with red and white shimashima arrows may be the most unfamiliar sight for out-of-road travelers. This is a sign indicating the boundary with the shoulder so that the location can be seen even if the white line (outer line) indicating the boundary of the road is no longer visible in winter when snow accumulates. It is a signpost that can be relied on when visibility is poor due to blizzards, etc.



Stop line signboard

Like the pole with arrow blades, it is a sign indicating the stop position so that you can know the position even if you can't see the stop line on the road due to snow. There is not necessarily a stop line just before the traffic light, so please check the sign carefully before stopping.



Animal warning sign

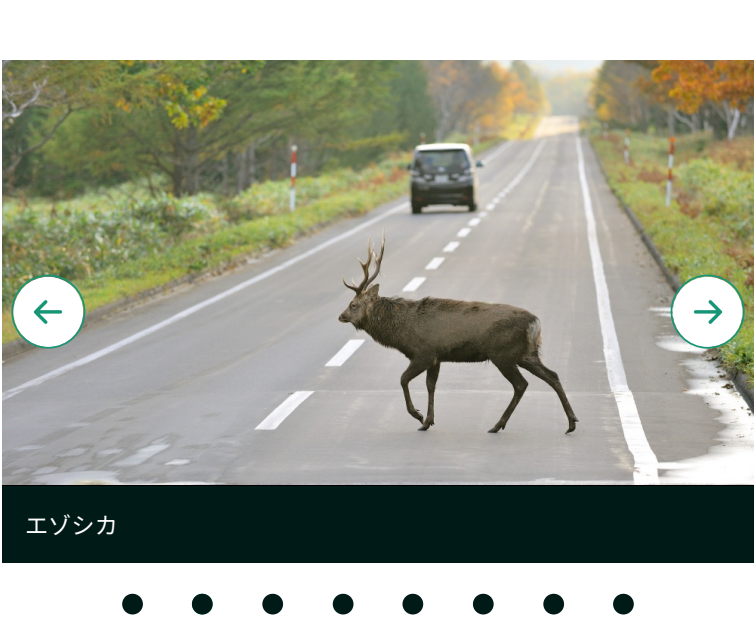
Wild animals and grazing cows are free-willed. It is not uncommon to cross the road. Especially in areas where animals are easy to pass, there are signs that say "Animal Warning". There are various pictures written, such as cows, deer, and foxes. Let's be aware that we are disturbing the nature where animals live.

Column

Vertical smart traffic light

In areas with a lot of snow, including Hokkaido, vertical traffic lights are used to prevent bending or breaking due to the weight of snow. In addition, if snow accumulates on the eaves that covers the lens, visibility will decrease, and in the worst case, it may be mistaken. To prevent this from happening, vertical traffic lights are the mainstream.

If you encounter a wild animal



エゾシカ

It is not uncommon to encounter wild animals when you leave the city and go to the suburbs. It's so cute that I want to touch it, such as foxes and deers, but it's not good to approach or feed them. Because wild animals are more likely to have diseases, and we are also at risk of being infected. Also, if you get used to receiving food from humans, the animal may not be able to live in the wild. Even if it's cute, let's hold on and watch from afar.

If you come into contact with a large animal while driving, please report it to "#9910". It is best to wait for instructions without leaving it in place or trying to touch it unnerissingly.

In addition, it is rare to encounter wild bears in tourist attractions, but they may come down to the sem from late summer to early autumn when there is a shortage of food. Especially when visiting a hyarm habitat such as mountainous areas and Shiretoko, prepare a bear bell or take defensive measures according to local precautions. It is also important to collect information in advance.

Shiretoko Foundation official website →
Wild animals →

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